While laying down the doctrine of literal interpretation, Justice Mukherjea said[88]: "In interpreting the provisions of our constitution, we should go by the plain words used by the constitution-makers".

The doctrine of literal interpretation says that the Constitution must be interpreted with reference to its terms and those alone; nothing is to be read into it on grounds of some supposed spirit pervading the Constitution, or on the ground of policy or even for the purpose of supplying omissions or of correcting errors[89].

The Supreme Court, in the above context, made the following observation[90]:

"The courts are not at liberty to declare an Act void because in their opinion it is opposed to a spirit supposed to pervade the Constitution but not expressed in words. Where the fundamental law has not limited, either in terms or by necessary implication, the general powers conferred upon the Legislature, courts cannot declare a limitation upon the motion of having discovered something in the spirit of the Constitution which is not even mentioned in the statute. It is difficult upon any general principles to limit the omnipotence of the sovereign legislative power by judicial interpretation, except so far as the express words of a written Constitution give that authority."

3. Doctrine of Purposive Interpretation

The doctrine of purposive interpretation says that the courts, while making an interpretation of the Constitution, should look into the purpose for incorporating a provision in the Constitution. It emphasizes that the constitutional interpretation should ascertain the intention of the makers of the Constitution.

The Preamble to the Constitution and the Constituent Assembly Debates throws a light on the purposes of the constitutional provisions and the intent of the constitution-makers. Sir Alladi Krishnaswamy Ayyar, a member of the Drafting Committee of the Constituent Assembly said: "The Preamble to our Constitution expresses what we had thought or dreamt so long". Similarly, in the *Berubari Union* case[91] (1960), the Supreme Court said that the Preamble is a key to the minds of the makers of the Constitution.

While making an argument in favour of the doctrine of purposive interpretation, the Supreme Court made the following observation[92]:

"Constitutional provisions are required to be understood and interpreted with an object-oriented approach. A Constitution must not be construed in a narrow and pedantic sense. The words used may be general in terms but, their full import and true meaning, has to be appreciated considering the true context in which the same are used and the purpose which they seek to achieve."

Similarly, the former Chief Justice of India, J.S. Verma, while advocating the doctrine of purposive interpretation, said as follows[93]:

"The Constitution is to be interpreted as a living and vibrant organism to provide for the current societal needs. Constitution is to be construed as enacting concepts. In construing a provision of the Constitution, the constitutional purpose it is meant to subserve has to be borne in mind."

4. Doctrine of Creative Interpretation